

The Retail AI/ML Portfolio Command Center

Evaluating and Prioritizing the Top 30 High-Yield AI Investments

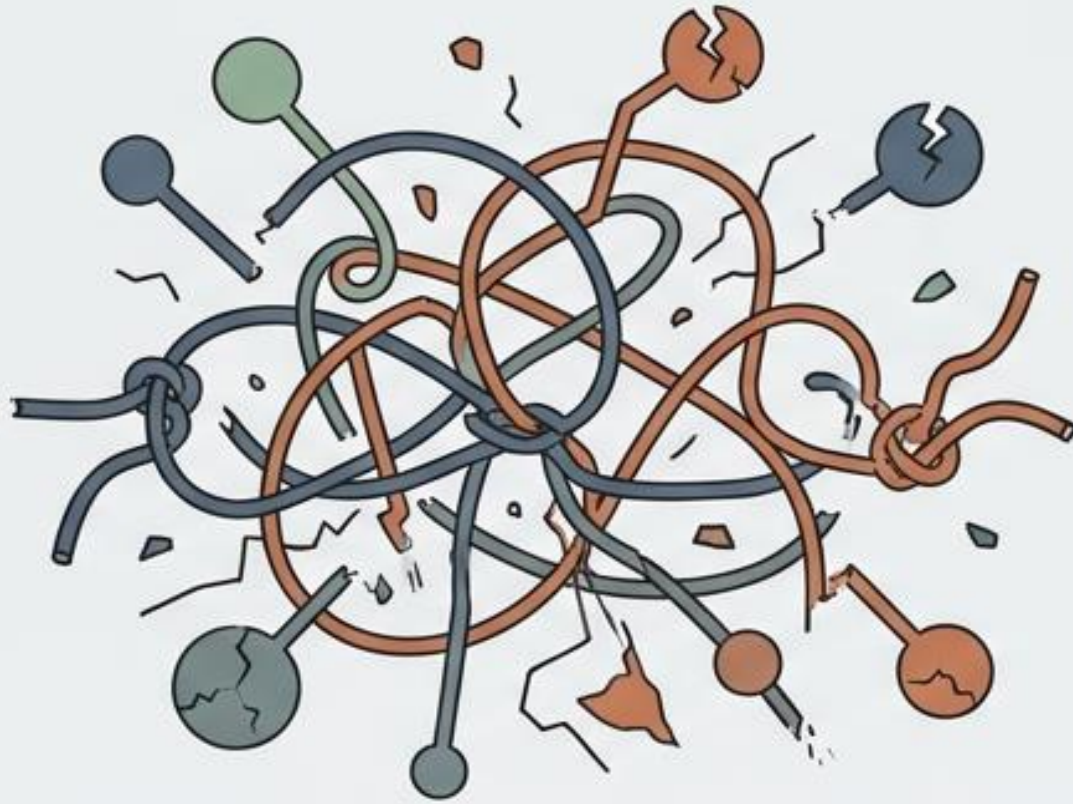
Growth & Efficiency Matrix

Board-Level Executive Briefing

Calsoft Strategic Advisory



Isolated Pilots



Current retail transformation spans omnichannel, mobile, and social commerce. However, AI adoption is currently trapped in siloed experiments—basic chatbots, disconnected AR, and localized supply chain tweaks.

Integrated Intelligence



The next phase requires converting these isolated initiatives into a board-level, rigorously managed portfolio of prioritized AI/ML use cases.

The Prioritization Mandate: Every initiative must be evaluated against three strict criteria

1. Business Outcome
(Growth vs. Efficiency)

2. Speed to Value
(Wave 1, 2, or 3)

3. Data Readiness
(Availability & Cleanliness)

Calsoft Focus Areas:

Marketing Analytics

Customer Experience

Merchandising

Supply Chain

Data & Analytics

GenAI

30 Strategic Bets Across 5 Operational Domains



Domain 01: Customer Experience

Hyper-personalization & Discovery

The first and most visible AI battleground. Transforming seamless experiences across online, mobile, and physical stores to improve conversion and reduce friction.

Hyper-personalized Recommendations

Web, app, and store channel matching.



Growth



Data:
High



Speed: Fast
(Wave 1)

Personalized Buying Assistants

Conversational guidance to the right product.



Growth



Data:
Med



Speed:
Med

Next-Best-Offer Engines

Triggers to improve conversion and basket size.



Growth



Data:
High



Speed:
Fast

Visual Search & Discovery

Image-led search to improve findability.



Efficiency/
Growth



Data:
Med



Speed:
Med

AR-Based Virtual Try-on

Assisted journeys to reduce uncertainty and returns.



Growth



Data:
Low



Speed:
Slow

Churn & Loyalty Propensity Models

Triggered retention interventions.



Efficiency



Data:
High



Speed: Med
(Wave 2)

Domain 02: Merchandising

Guiding Price, Assortment,
and Placement.

AI-driven precision to
balance demand,
competition, and margin
while optimizing inventory
decisions across all
regions and seasons.

Dynamic Pricing Engines

Balancing demand,
competition, and
margin.



Growth



Data:
High



Speed: Fast
(Wave 1)

Competitor Price Monitoring

Intelligence across
marketplaces and
channels.



Efficiency



Data:
Med



Speed:
Fast

Promotion Optimization

Targeting offers by
geography, persona,
and buying signal.



Growth



Data:
High



Speed:
Med

Assortment Planning

Optimizing SKU mix by
store, region, channel,
and season.



Efficiency



Data:
Med



Speed: Med
(Wave 2)

Demand Forecasting

Product and category-
level inventory
foresight.



Efficiency



Data:
High



Speed: Fast
(Wave 1)

Product Matching & Digital Shelf

Analytics for discovery
and compliance.



Growth



Data:
Med



Speed:
Med

Domain 03: Operational Efficiency

Orchestrating Inventory,
Fulfillment, & Execution.

Smarter supply chain
operations designed to
reduce cost-to-serve,
eliminate stock-outs, and
streamline omnichannel
order flows.

Smart Inventory Management

Reducing stock-outs
and overstocks.



Efficiency



Data:
Med



Speed: Med

Automated Replenishment

Responding to near-
real-time demand
patterns.



Efficiency



Data:
High



Speed: Med
(Wave 2)

Warehouse Optimization

Improving picking,
routing, and labor
productivity.



Efficiency



Data:
Low



Speed:
Slow

Omnichannel Order Mgmt.

Optimization across
complex fulfillment
flows.



Efficiency



Data:
High



Speed: Med
(Wave 2)

Logistics, Route & Fleet Optimization

Real-time tracking and
delivery efficiency.



Efficiency



Data:
Med



Speed:
Fast

Store Vision AI

Queue analytics, dwell
time, heat maps, and
journey analysis.



Efficiency



Data:
Low



Speed: Fast
(Wave 1)

Domain 04: Customer Support

The AI-Led Resolution Engine.

Shifting support from a cost center to an intelligent resolution layer that reduces triage time and up-skills human agents in real time.

24x7 AI Chatbots

Support, order tracking, and product assistance.



Efficiency



Data:
High



Speed: Fast
(Wave 1)

L0-L2 Support Copilots

Scanning knowledge bases for auto-resolution.



Efficiency



Data:
High



Speed: Med
(Wave 2)

Intelligent Ticket Triage

Routing to reduce resolution time and cost.



Efficiency



Data:
High



Speed: Fast

Real-time Agent-Assist

Troubleshooting steps and training in real-time.



Efficiency



Data:
Med



Speed: Med

Voice-of-Customer Mining

Identifying service issues from raw feedback.



Efficiency



Data:
High



Speed: Med

Omnichannel Feedback Analytics

Surfacing structural improvement opportunities.



Growth



Data:
High



Speed: Med

Domain 05: First-Party Data Monetization

New High-Margin
Growth Engines.

Packaging internal
intelligence into external
products. Combining
permissioned behavioral
data and machine learning
to build transformational
revenue streams.

Retail Media Networks (RMN)

Supplier bidding for
sponsored
placements.



Supplier Insight Dashboards

Anonymized
data-as-a-service
offerings.



ML Propensity for Media ROI

Increasing precision
and supplier targeting
value.



1P Behavioral Audience Segments

Products built from
permissioned
customer data.



Buying-Intent Intelligence

Combining internal/
external data for
partner monetization.

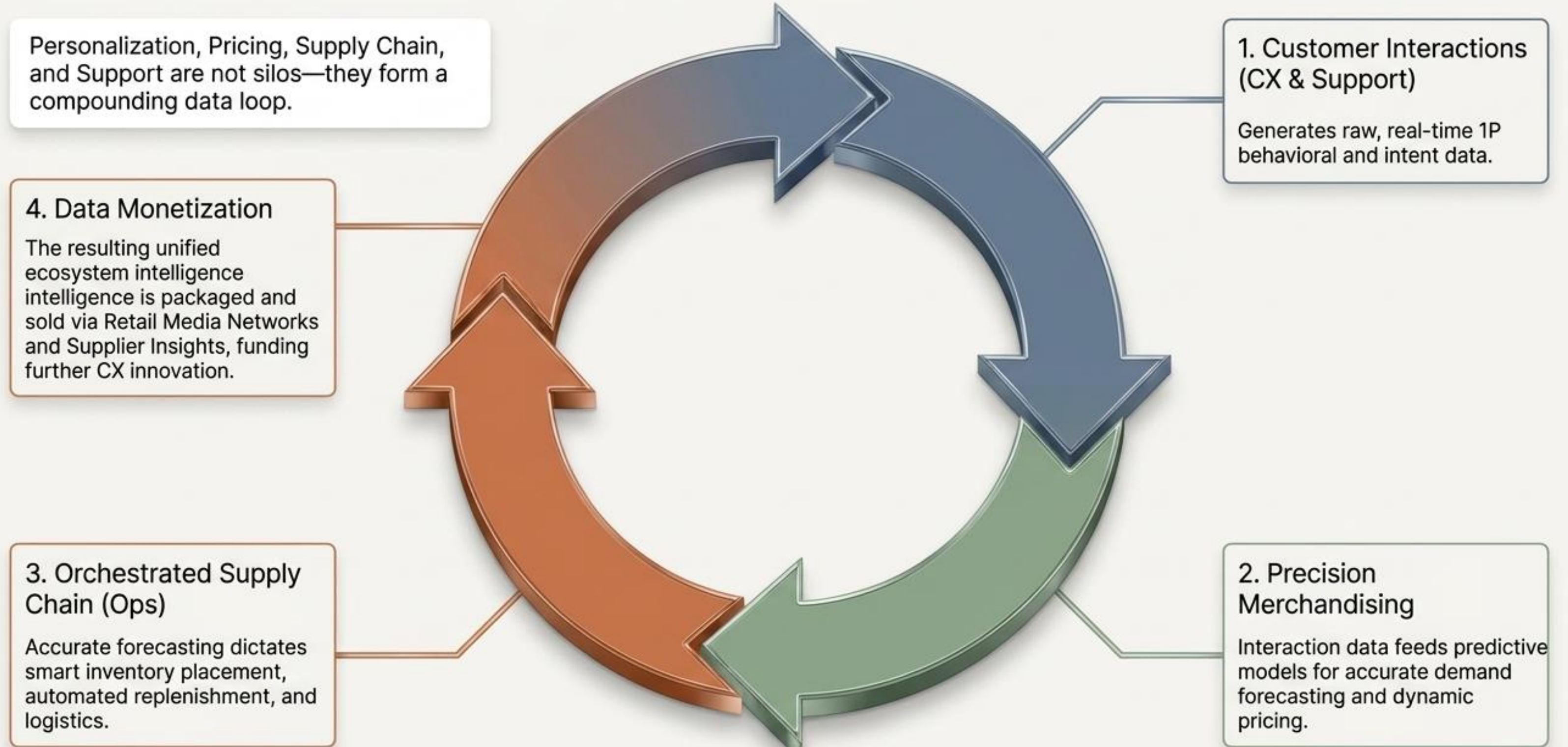


CLV & Retention Analytics

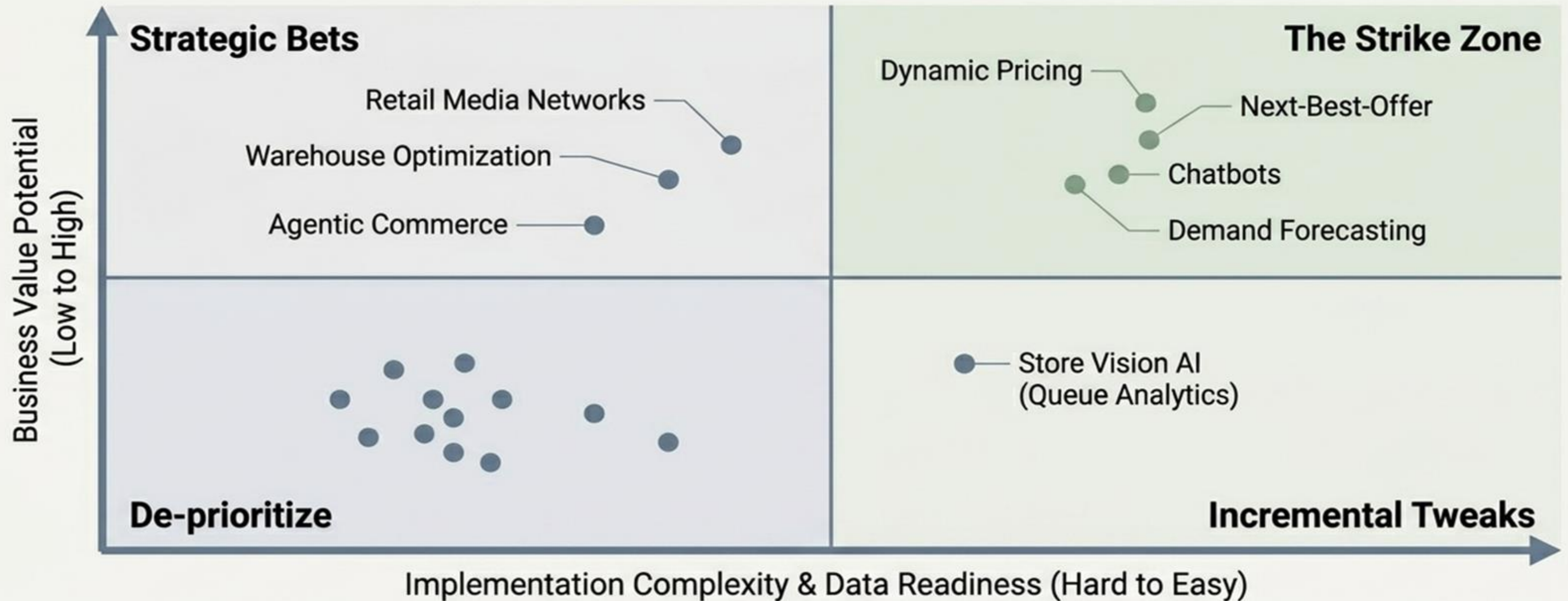
Actionable growth
programs sold to
brands.



The Integrated Retail AI Flywheel



The Prioritization Diagnostic



Executive Takeaway: Direct immediate capital allocation to Strike Zone Quick Wins, while establishing data infrastructure for Transformational Strategic Bets.

The Actionable Deployment Roadmap

Wave 1: Quick Wins (Months 1-6)

Focus:
Extracting immediate value
from existing high-readiness
data.

Key Deployments:
24x7 Chatbots, Recommendation
Engines, Category Demand Forecasting,
Dynamic Pricing, Store Queue Analytics

Wave 2: Scale Programs (Months 6-18)

Focus:
Complex operational
orchestration and cross-
channel intelligence

Key Deployments:
Assortment Planning, Automated
Replenishment, Omnichannel Order
Optimization, L0-L2 Support Copilots,
Churn Prediction Models

Wave 3: Transformational Bets (Months 18-36)

Focus:
Launching entirely new high-
margin business models

Key Deployments:
Integrated Agentic Commerce, Retail
Media Networks (RMN), 1P Data
Monetization, Omnipresent Customer
Intelligence

Operating Model Integration & Next Steps



Step 01: Audit Data Availability

Map existing internal data lakes and pipelines strictly against the requirements for the targeted Wave 1 Quick Wins (e.g., dynamic pricing feeds).



Step 02: Assess Operating-Model Fit

Align merchandising, digital, and supply chain teams on shared KPIs to prevent siloed AI adoption and ensure cross-functional data fluidity.



Step 03: Establish the Portfolio Committee

Form a cross-functional CXO steering group to govern capital allocation, track telemetry, and measure value realization across the 30 use cases.